

A BOILERPLATE XUL ADD-ON

Should we put our knowledge to some
use and create a template? Let's do that!

The core purpose of this Fast Track is to acquaint the reader with what it means to write code for the Firefox platform, and how it could be done. With that in mind, let's go ahead and test the waters, just to see what it feels like. We'll work on a rather straightforward codebase.

What codebase is more straightforward than code that's not supposed to do anything? No finding problems, or scrutinising for other specifics, and examining without the pressure of trying to figure out "how does that work?" Beginning with the understanding that programming is a tough task, it would probably be in your best interest if we started with something so 'boilerplate' that there's almost nothing on the plate. That way, you'd be able to examine a template that, howsoever correct, is still easy enough to grasp the underlying architecture and design principles, while serving as a base for extensive revisits and eventually development in the future. However, that's not something we'll be doing in this particular booklet (not specifically XUL, that is).